couple of decent pace bowlers. Obviously they are taking the game dead seriously, so you can't just mess around. But sometimes the opposition isn't too strong and, if the mood takes you, you can haul out the long handle and have a good old tonk. In one game, big-hitting New Zealander Chris Cairns let loose and helped himself to a 100 off about 30 balls.

Look, there's still a lot of pride at stake in these matches, and the Lashings CC very seldom lose a game. To give everyone a fair chance, we always bat first – it's best to get some runs on the board, as it's no fun when someone's paid money to watch the game if the opposition bat first and we proceed to get them out for next to nothing.

I've had great times with the team, and David Folb has always said he would love me to come back any year. Apparently my willingness to sign autographs and be part of all the social events adds value to the team … which is all good with me, because I want to continue playing for this great institution.

Life after cricket

I have no idea what I'm going to do when I finish cricket. Seriously. No plan whatsoever. I probably know more about what I *don't* want to do than what I want to do. I don't, for example, want to get into coaching. Yes, the post-rehab Herschelle has enjoyed passing on his experience to the younger guys, but I also know from having played under so many coaches that it's a very complex job. It takes a lot of organisational skill and a practical mind, and that just isn't me. Ja, me a coach. It's amusing even to think about it.

I've also always been an instinctive player relying on his natural abilities, and so have never been very analytical about my game – or anyone else's game. But I think being able to pick apart your opponents' defences is a vital skill for a coach. I basically had to work out for myself what was required to perform well at international level. I was never technically good, like a Tendulkar or a Kallis, and have always relied on my hand-eye coordination.

What I had to learn was how to be disciplined at the crease – particularly as an opener in Test cricket. I had to learn where my off-stump is all the time, which meant I could leave balls with much greater confidence – and on a really good wicket, you can even leave on length.

So, no coaching for me. I can't see myself in any kind of corporate environment either. And I'm sure I don't even have to explain why. I have